

film review

Batting Right

CHAIN KULI KI MAIN KULI

Starring: Zain Khan, Rahul Bose

Directed by: Kituu Salooja

In principle, making an inspirational cricket film is a good idea, especially at a time when the Indian child's faith in our World Cup heroes is at an all-

time low. But when the film tries too desperately to ape Nagesh Kukunoor's luminous *Iqbal*, yet another rags-to-riches story of a cricketing minnow becoming a mega-hero, then warning bells begin to ring. That's what happens with *Chain Kuli ki Main Kuli*. It's one of those movies which seem to push all the right but-

Zain Khan (R) in the film



tons— orphaned child living in a home with a Fagin-like master discovers a magic bat among some discarded toys and becomes an overnight saviour of the Indian team, preventing them from being thrashed by, who else, but Pakistan. Child (Zain Khan) teaches captain (Rahul Bose) the essence of happiness while captain instructs him on how to tie shoelaces—cue to audience to weep. What saves the film from being trite is the magnificent Zain Khan. Here's a boy who can act, wispy little moustache and adolescent crackle, notwithstanding. It's a film that children will coast through for its uncomplicated values, and in Khan, they at least have a 13-year-old who is neither precociously cute nor preachily unreal.

by Kaveree Bamzai

music

Strings of Promise

GIRISH GV



DELHI To mark the midpoint of the timeline for the Millennium Development Goals, the United Nations in India is organising a concert "Keep the Promise" on July 7. The artistes are young musicians—the Carnatic violin brothers, Ganesh and Kumaresh followed by Rahul Sharma, who will present santoor fusion. Be there. At the Kamani Auditorium.

recommendations

Music in Valley

CHENNAI After a weekend of heavy head-banging, Chennai is now gearing up for a live, light music concert that will feature leading playback singers from the South Indian film industry. Conceived and conceptualised by Humma.com, a **Ranjith, Naresh and Devan (Left to Right)**



music website, the concert will be held on July 8 at the Music Academy. In addition to showcasing popular singers like Naresh Iyer, Devan, Ranjith, Suchitra, Mahathi and Madhumita, the show aims to provide a platform for three upcoming singers who will make their debut through this show. City-based Jon Britto's dance troupe will only add zing to the show.

by Akhila Krishnamurthy

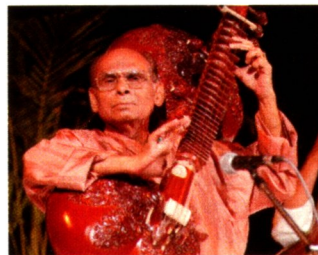
SRINAGAR Mystic goes pop. It is Sufi time in Srinagar right now. The Indian Council for Cultural Relations presents a three-day festival from July 2-4. The line-up is a mix of dance and music. On the opening day listen to Sufiana kalam by Chand Afzal qawwal followed by Adil Barki from Pakistan. Begum Fareeda



AVINASH PASRICHA

Prerna Shrimali

Khanum will sing some memorable ghazals followed by folk dance by Tannoura Sufi from Egypt. The festival closes with Sufi Kathak by Prerna Shrimali and semi-classical songs by Rita Ganguly, a disciple of Begum Akhtar. For a change listen to some soulful music than gun shots.



SIPRA DAS

Ustad Asad Ali Khan
DELHI Organised by the Soporl Academy of Music and Performing Arts, Sangeet Vibhuti believes in being different. Spear-headed by santoor maestro, Pandit Bhajan Sopori, it does not feature oft-repeated musicians in the concert circuit. The festival will see Shanno Dagar (veena) and Ustad Asad Ali Khan's performance on July 3. Khan will play the rudra veena, which does not find many takers today. Enjoy Ustad Fahimuddin Dagar (dhrupad), Ustad Faiyaz Khan (tabla) and Pandit Vidyadhar Vyas's (vocal) music on July 4. At the India Habitat Centre. **by S. Sahaya Ranjit**